

Make Hard Work Your Passion: Execution, Featuring Marie Mouchet

Marie Mouchet, VP & CIO Colonial Pipeline Company

There is a difference between working hard and making hard work your passion. When you are passionate about the work you do, you approach every endeavor with concentration and perspective. Pat said, “You have 40 minutes to win, but you have to do it one possession at a time.”

Pat Summitt’s 40-minute concept is useful in multiple professional settings. In sales, for example, when it comes time to make a big presentation, the preparation should already be done. Now it’s time to execute your plan, and the most important thing to have in that moment is confidence. Practiced presenters won’t scramble for words, sweat the time, or be distracted by the competition.

Pat Summitt made sure her players were focused on winning and executing the game plan under pressure. Pressure tests the integrity of your preparation. As obstacles arise, maintain your perspective by practicing these simple methods. Start by tackling the undesirable task first. When you’re facing something you don’t want to do, start with the difficult task. The task you dislike tend to drain your energy the most. So completing them while you’re still alert will give you more opportunity to make sure the task is done well.

Next, emphasize the positive aspects in an unfavorable situation. If you’re in a moment or season where you’re working on something that’s merely a steppingstone to where you ultimately want to end up, take time to focus on what is meaningful in the present. Oftentimes, in the rush to get ahead, we can miss opportunities for development that are right in front of us.

And finally, live life self-employed. When you invest in your dreams, you invest in yourself. The unexpected may threaten to set you back on your path to victory, but you can control how you respond to whatever comes your way. Lean on your commitment, trust your preparation, and continue working hard toward executing your vision of success.